



Department of MBA 2026

A Study on Student Counselling and Admission Processes in Online Higher Education with Reference to UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

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**A dissertation submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for
the degree of Master Of Business Administration**

**PES University, Bangalore
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Master of Business Administration

This is to certify that I have examined this copy of an internship dissertation by VINAYAK HALINGALI [PES1PG24MB470] and have found it complete and satisfactory in all respects,

and that all revisions required by the final examining committee have been made.

Internal Supervisor: _____ Date: _____

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DECLARATION BY THE CANDIDATE

I hereby declare that the internship project report entitled "**A Study on Student Counselling and Admission Processes in Online Higher Education with Reference to UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd**" in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of degree of Master of Business Administration submitted to Department of MBA, PES University, Bangalore is an authentic and original internship work carried out by me under the guidance and supervision of Prof. Deepak Shyam. During the period from **February 2026 to July 2026** I state that this report is not submitted in part or full to award certificate, diploma and/or degree of any other University or Institution. I further declare that the material/literature obtained from various sources is being duly acknowledged and the report is free from plagiarism and within the permissible level.

Signature and Name of the Student

VINAYAK HALINGALI

Date: _____

Place: BENGALURU

CERTIFICATE FROM THE SUPERVISOR

This is to certify that the work incorporated in the project report entitled " **A Study on Student Counselling and Admission Processes in Online Higher Education with Reference to UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd** " is a record of work carried out by **Vinayak Halingali**,
[SRN PES1PG24MB470].

Under my guidance and supervision for the award of Degree of Master of Business Administration

in the Department of MBA of PES University, Bangalore, India. To the best of my/our knowledge and belief the project report embodies the work of the candidate and fulfils the requirement of the Ordinance relating to the Degree of Master of Business Administration of the University. The project report is up to the desired standards both in respect of contents and publication ethics and is free from plagiarism and or prescribed level.

Signature and Name of the Supervisor

Signature and Name of the Dean

Comments:

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Place: Bengaluru Date:

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Executive Summary

This project focuses on analyzing student admissions, lead conversion performance, and enrollment trends at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., an Ed-Tech company offering online degree and certification programs in collaboration with reputed universities. As an Admission Officer, my role involved handling student inquiries, counseling prospective learners, explaining program details, following up on leads, and converting them into confirmed enrollments. During the internship period, I observed that while a large number of leads were generated through digital marketing campaigns, not all leads were successfully converted into admissions. Therefore, this study aims to analyze the admission funnel, identify key factors affecting conversions, and suggest strategies to improve enrollment performance.

The dataset used for this study consisted of internal admission and lead management records including total leads received, follow-up attempts, student responses, application submissions, fee payments, and final enrollments. The data was collected from the company's CRM system over a specific period during my internship. The research primarily used secondary data provided by the organization, along with primary observations from daily counseling interactions with students.

The analysis was conducted using tools such as Microsoft Excel for data cleaning, tabulation, trend analysis, and graphical representation. Statistical methods such as percentage analysis, trend analysis, and conversion ratio calculations were applied to evaluate performance at each stage of the admission funnel. The lead funnel was analyzed in the following stages:

- Total Leads Generated
- Contacted Leads
- Interested Students
- Applications Submitted
- Fee Paid / Confirmed Admissions

The study identified that the highest drop-off occurred between the “Interested” stage and the “Fee Payment” stage. Major reasons included financial constraints, lack of decision-making support from family, comparison with competitors, and delay in follow-up communication. It was also observed that faster follow-ups and personalized counseling significantly improved conversion rates.

Trend analysis was conducted to evaluate monthly admission performance. The results showed fluctuations in enrollment numbers based on marketing campaign intensity, intake deadlines, scholarship offers, and seasonal demand. Periods with promotional discounts and limited-time scholarships showed comparatively higher conversion ratios.

Hypothesis testing was performed to examine the relationship between follow-up frequency and conversion rate. The analysis supported the hypothesis that increased structured follow-ups positively influence student enrollment decisions. Another hypothesis tested whether detailed program counseling impacts enrollment probability, and the findings indicated that students who received complete academic and career guidance were more likely to enroll.

Key findings of the study include:

- Effective follow-up strategy is the most critical factor influencing admissions.
- Timely communication increases student trust and reduces dropout in the funnel.
- Financial counseling and EMI explanation improve fee payment conversions.
- Personalized interaction performs better than generic communication.
- Scholarship campaigns significantly boost short-term enrollment numbers.

Based on these findings, several recommendations were proposed:

- Implement structured follow-up schedules within CRM.
- Provide detailed objection-handling training to admission officers.
- Introduce flexible payment options and better EMI communication.
- Use data-driven lead prioritization to focus on high-intent students.
- Strengthen post-counseling engagement through reminder calls and WhatsApp support.

The study concludes that admission performance in an Ed-Tech organization is highly dependent on systematic lead management, communication quality, and relationship-building skills of admission officers. By optimizing the admission funnel and adopting data-driven strategies, UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. can significantly improve conversion efficiency, reduce lead wastage, and increase overall revenue.

This project not only helped the organization understand gaps in its admission process but also enhanced my practical understanding of sales analytics, student psychology, CRM handling, and performance tracking in the Ed-Tech industry.

CHAPTER - 1

1.1 INTRODUCTION

Internships play a significant role in management education by bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge acquired in classrooms and practical exposure gained in the corporate environment. While academic programs provide students with conceptual understanding of business functions, internships offer an opportunity to observe, learn, and participate in real organizational activities. For MBA students, internships serve as an essential platform for understanding industry practices, developing professional competencies, and preparing themselves for future managerial responsibilities.

The rapid advancement of digital technology has transformed several industries, and the education sector is one of the most prominent examples. Online higher education has emerged as a preferred learning mode for students and working professionals who seek flexibility, affordability, and quality education without geographical limitations. Educational technology (Ed-Tech) companies have played a major role in making higher education more accessible through digital platforms, virtual classrooms, learning management systems, and online student support services.

Among the leading organizations contributing to this transformation is UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., an Ed-Tech company that collaborates with reputed universities to deliver online degree programs across India. The organization provides comprehensive admission counselling, student support, and technology-enabled learning solutions through the Online Manipal platform. By partnering with prestigious universities such as Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ), and Sikkim Manipal University (SMU), the company enables students to pursue recognized undergraduate and postgraduate programs from any location.

As part of the MBA internship program, the researcher completed an internship at UNext

Learning Pvt. Ltd. in the role of Admission Officer (Education Counsellor). The primary responsibility involved interacting with prospective students, understanding their educational aspirations, counselling them regarding suitable academic programs, explaining admission procedures, assisting with documentation, managing customer relationship management (CRM) software, and supporting students throughout the admission process until successful enrollment.

The internship provided comprehensive exposure to multiple aspects of student relationship management, customer engagement, lead generation, counselling strategies, communication techniques, sales conversion, and operational coordination. It also helped in understanding the importance of effective communication, customer-centric service, data management, and teamwork in achieving organizational objectives.

This internship report has been prepared to present a systematic analysis of the organizational environment, industry practices, job responsibilities, practical learning experiences, and the application of management concepts acquired during the MBA program. The report also highlights how classroom knowledge was integrated with practical business operations in an Ed-Tech organization and examines the contribution of admission counselling towards enhancing student satisfaction and organizational performance.

Furthermore, the report aims to evaluate the functioning of admission management in online higher education and identify the practical skills, managerial competencies, and professional ethics developed during the internship. The findings presented in this report are based on direct observation, organizational practices, personal experience, and interactions with mentors, colleagues, and prospective students throughout the internship period.

Overall, the internship served as an enriching learning experience that strengthened the understanding of management principles while providing valuable exposure to the rapidly growing online education industry. It enhanced professional confidence, interpersonal communication, analytical thinking, and decision-making abilities, thereby contributing significantly to personal and career development.

1.2 Background of the Study

The higher education sector has experienced a remarkable transformation over the past decade due to the rapid adoption of digital technologies and internet-based learning platforms. The traditional classroom model, which once dominated the education system, has gradually evolved into a flexible and technology-driven learning environment. The increasing demand for accessible, affordable, and career-oriented education has accelerated the growth of online higher education, making it one of the fastest-growing segments within the education industry.

In India, the digital revolution, improved internet connectivity, government initiatives promoting digital education, and the changing learning preferences of students and working professionals have significantly contributed to the expansion of online education. Universities and educational institutions are increasingly offering online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs that provide the same academic value as conventional classroom education while allowing learners to study according to their own schedules.

The emergence of Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) companies has further strengthened this transformation. These organizations bridge the gap between universities and learners by providing advanced technological platforms, student counselling services, digital classrooms, learning management systems, academic support, and admission assistance. Their role extends beyond technology, as they actively assist prospective students in selecting suitable academic programs based on their educational background, career aspirations, financial capabilities, and personal interests.

UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. is one of the prominent organizations operating in India's rapidly growing Ed-Tech industry. Through its Online Manipal platform, the company collaborates with reputed universities to provide high-quality online education across various disciplines. The organization focuses on delivering comprehensive educational solutions that include admission counselling, student relationship management, enrollment support, and continuous

learner engagement throughout the academic journey.

The company partners with prestigious universities such as Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ), and Sikkim Manipal University (SMU). These institutions offer a wide range of online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs in fields including management, commerce, computer applications, information technology, arts, and business administration. These programs are designed to meet the educational requirements of fresh graduates, working professionals, entrepreneurs, and individuals seeking career advancement through flexible learning opportunities.

Student counselling has become one of the most critical functions within the online higher education ecosystem. Many prospective learners require professional guidance before selecting an academic program because they often face challenges related to course selection, university recognition, fee structures, eligibility criteria, career prospects, scholarship opportunities, and admission procedures. Admission counsellors play a vital role in helping students make informed decisions by understanding their individual needs and recommending programs that align with their career objectives.

Apart from counselling, the admission process itself involves multiple stages, including lead generation, lead qualification, follow-up communication, document verification, fee payment assistance, application submission, and enrollment confirmation. Effective management of these activities requires strong communication skills, customer relationship management (CRM) systems, teamwork, and a student-centric approach.

As part of the MBA internship, the researcher was assigned the role of Admission Officer (Education Counsellor) at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. The internship provided direct exposure to the practical functioning of admission counselling and student relationship management within a professional corporate environment. Responsibilities included interacting with prospective students, understanding their educational requirements, providing detailed information about university programs, resolving admission-related queries, assisting students throughout the admission process, maintaining CRM records, and coordinating with

internal departments to ensure timely enrollment.

This study has been undertaken to understand the operational aspects of student counselling and admission management in the online higher education sector. It also seeks to evaluate how management principles such as customer relationship management, communication, marketing, organizational behaviour, and business analytics are applied in a real-world corporate setting. The internship has enabled the researcher to bridge the gap between academic learning and practical implementation while gaining valuable industry insights that contribute to professional growth and career development.

1.3 Need for the Study

The education sector is undergoing continuous transformation due to technological advancements and changing learner expectations. The increasing popularity of online education has created a need for organizations that can effectively connect students with suitable educational opportunities while ensuring a smooth admission experience. As competition among universities and educational service providers continues to increase, the quality of student counselling and admission management has become an important factor influencing enrollment decisions and overall student satisfaction.

This study has been undertaken to understand the practical functioning of admission counselling and student relationship management within the online higher education industry. While classroom learning provides theoretical knowledge regarding marketing, communication, customer relationship management, organizational behaviour, and business analytics, practical exposure is necessary to understand how these concepts are implemented in a corporate environment.

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. offered an opportunity to observe and participate in the complete admission lifecycle, beginning with the generation of student inquiries and ending with successful enrollment. Through this experience, the researcher gained valuable insights into counselling techniques, customer relationship management, lead conversion strategies, admission procedures, and operational coordination among different organizational departments.

Another important reason for conducting this study is the growing importance of personalized student counselling in online education. Every learner possesses unique educational qualifications, career aspirations, financial conditions, and professional goals. Therefore, admission counsellors must possess strong interpersonal communication skills, analytical thinking, emotional intelligence, and problem-solving abilities to provide appropriate guidance. Understanding these practical requirements helps bridge the gap between academic concepts and industry expectations.

The study is also significant because it examines the contribution of Ed-Tech companies toward improving access to higher education in India. Organizations such as UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. have expanded educational opportunities for students residing in remote areas and for working professionals seeking career advancement without leaving their employment. The research highlights how technology-enabled counselling and digital admission systems contribute to improving educational accessibility, operational efficiency, and learner satisfaction.

Furthermore, this study provides an opportunity to evaluate the practical application of MBA concepts in a real business environment. Subjects such as Marketing Management, Human Resource Management, Organizational Behaviour, Business Communication, Customer Relationship Management, and Business Analytics have direct relevance to the daily responsibilities performed during the internship. Analyzing these applications enhances both academic understanding and professional competence.

Finally, the findings of this study may serve as a useful reference for future management students, educators, and organizations interested in understanding the operational practices of student counselling and admission management in the online higher education sector. The report also presents recommendations that may contribute to improving organizational performance and customer satisfaction within the rapidly evolving Ed-Tech industry.

1.4 Statement of the Problem

The rapid growth of online higher education has significantly increased the demand for professional admission counselling and efficient student relationship management. While online learning provides flexibility and accessibility, many prospective students encounter difficulties in selecting the most appropriate academic program due to the availability of multiple universities, courses, fee structures, eligibility criteria, and career opportunities. These challenges often create confusion and hesitation during the admission process.

Ed-Tech companies act as a bridge between universities and learners by offering counselling services that help students make informed educational decisions. However, counsellors frequently face several practical challenges while interacting with prospective learners. Students may have limited awareness regarding online education, doubts about the credibility of online degrees, concerns about placement opportunities, financial constraints, and uncertainty regarding admission procedures. Addressing these concerns requires effective communication, product knowledge, empathy, patience, and problem-solving abilities.

Another challenge lies in converting student inquiries into successful admissions. Admission counsellors are responsible for managing a large number of student leads received through various marketing channels. Each lead requires timely follow-up, personalized guidance, accurate information, and continuous engagement until the admission process is completed. Failure to maintain effective communication may result in a loss of potential admissions and reduced organizational performance.

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. provided an opportunity to observe these challenges in a real corporate environment. The researcher identified that achieving admission targets while simultaneously maintaining high-quality counselling and customer satisfaction requires a combination of communication skills, customer relationship management, teamwork, analytical thinking, and effective use of CRM technology.

Therefore, this study seeks to examine the student counselling process, admission management practices, and customer relationship strategies adopted by UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

1.5 Objectives of the Study

The objectives of the study provide a clear direction for the internship report and define the purpose of the research conducted during the internship period.

Primary Objective

To study the student counselling and admission processes in online higher education with reference to UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

Secondary Objectives

- To understand the organizational structure and business operations of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.
- To study the admission process followed for online undergraduate and postgraduate programs.
- To understand the responsibilities and role of an Admission Officer in the Ed-Tech industry.
- To examine the counselling techniques used while guiding prospective students.
- To study the application of Customer Relationship Management (CRM) in managing student inquiries and admissions.
- To analyze the practical implementation of management concepts learned during the MBA program.
- To understand the importance of communication, negotiation, and interpersonal skills in admission counselling.
- To evaluate the challenges encountered during student counselling and admission management.
- To identify the professional skills and competencies developed during the internship.
- To provide suitable recommendations for improving student counselling and admission management practices.

The above objectives guided the internship activities and formed the foundation for analyzing the practical learning experience acquired during the internship.

1.6 Scope of the Study

The scope of this study is limited to the internship carried out at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., an Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) company engaged in providing online higher education services through collaborations with reputed universities. The study primarily focuses on understanding the organizational practices related to student counselling, admission management, customer relationship management, and learner support services.

The report covers the complete admission journey beginning from the generation of student inquiries and extending until successful enrollment into online degree programs. It includes the process of student counselling, understanding educational requirements, explaining course details, guiding students regarding eligibility criteria, resolving admission-related queries, assisting with documentation, facilitating fee payment procedures, maintaining CRM records, and coordinating with internal departments for admission completion.

The study specifically examines the counselling and admission processes associated with the online degree programs offered by Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ), and Sikkim Manipal University (SMU). These universities provide a wide range of undergraduate and postgraduate programs that cater to fresh graduates, working professionals, entrepreneurs, and lifelong learners.

The internship also enabled the researcher to understand the practical application of various management concepts such as Marketing Management, Organizational Behaviour, Business Communication, Customer Relationship Management, Human Resource Management, and Business Analytics in a corporate setting. The study therefore integrates both theoretical knowledge acquired during the MBA program and practical experience gained through industry exposure.

Although the findings of this study are primarily based on observations and experiences at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., many of the concepts discussed are relevant to the broader Ed-Tech industry and may provide useful insights for organizations involved in online higher education and student relationship management.

1.7 Research Methodology

Research methodology refers to the systematic procedure adopted for collecting, analyzing, and interpreting information related to the study. It provides a structured framework for conducting research in a scientific and objective manner. For this internship report, the research methodology was designed to understand the functioning of student counselling and admission management at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

The study is primarily descriptive in nature as it focuses on describing the organizational practices, operational procedures, and learning experiences observed during the internship. A descriptive research design was selected because it allows a detailed understanding of real-world business operations without manipulating any variables.

The internship was carried out over a period of six months, during which the researcher actively participated in various organizational activities as an Admission Officer. The practical exposure enabled direct observation of admission procedures, student interactions, CRM operations, teamwork, and performance management practices.

The study relied on both qualitative and quantitative information. Qualitative information was obtained through observation, discussions with managers and colleagues, participation in counselling sessions, and analysis of organizational processes. Quantitative information included admission statistics, CRM reports, lead status updates, performance indicators, and daily activity reports wherever applicable.

The collected information was carefully analyzed to understand the relationship between theoretical management concepts and their practical implementation within the organization. Appropriate interpretations were made based on personal observations, internship experiences, and organizational practices.

The research methodology adopted for this study ensured that the internship report presents an authentic representation of the learning experience while maintaining academic rigor and professional standards.

1.8 Source of Data

The information presented in this internship report has been collected from both primary and secondary sources to ensure reliability and comprehensiveness.

Primary Data

Primary data refers to information collected directly by the researcher during the internship period. The primary sources used in this study include:

- Direct observation of daily organizational activities.
- Personal involvement in student counselling and admission processes.
- Interaction with reporting managers, team leaders, and colleagues.
- Discussions with prospective students and applicants.
- Experience gained while using CRM software.
- Participation in departmental meetings and training sessions.

The primary data provided first-hand insights into the functioning of the organization and formed the basis of the practical analysis presented in this report.

Secondary Data

Secondary data refers to information obtained from existing published and organizational sources. The secondary data used for this study include:

- Official website of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.
- Online Manipal website.
- Official websites of MAHE, MUJ, and SMU.
- Company brochures and admission manuals.
- University prospectuses.
- Internal training materials.
- Academic journals and research papers related to Ed-Tech.
- Books on Marketing, CRM, Organizational Behaviour, and Management.
- Government publications related to higher education.
- MBA course materials and lecture notes.

The combination of primary and secondary data enhanced the overall quality and credibility of the study.

1.9 Limitations of the Study

Like any academic research, the present study is subject to certain limitations that should be considered while interpreting its findings.

The study is confined to UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. and therefore may not represent the practices followed by all organizations operating within the Ed-Tech industry.

The internship duration was limited to six months, restricting the opportunity to observe long-term organizational developments and strategic changes.

Certain confidential organizational information related to business strategies, financial performance, internal policies, and proprietary technologies could not be included due to company confidentiality requirements.

The study is largely based on practical observations and experiences gained during the internship. Therefore, some findings may involve personal interpretations developed through direct participation in organizational activities.

The research primarily focuses on admission counselling and student relationship management rather than covering every functional department within the organization.

Despite these limitations, the study provides a realistic understanding of student counselling practices, admission management systems, and corporate learning experiences within the online higher education sector.

1.10 Chapter Summary

This chapter introduced the overall purpose and significance of the internship study conducted at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. It discussed the background of online higher education, the growing role of Ed-Tech companies, and the importance of student counselling in facilitating successful admissions. The chapter also presented the need for the study, the research problem, objectives, scope, research methodology, sources of data, and limitations of the research.

The discussion establishes the foundation for the remaining chapters of the report by outlining the context within which the internship was completed. It demonstrates how practical exposure complements classroom learning and contributes to the development of managerial competencies required in today's dynamic business environment.

The next chapter provides a comprehensive overview of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., including its organizational structure, business operations, products and services, corporate culture, and its role in transforming online higher education through technology-enabled learning solutions.

CHAPTER 2

ABOUT THE COMPANY & ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

2.1 Introduction of the Company

UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. is one of India's leading Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) companies dedicated to transforming higher education through innovative digital learning solutions. The organization operates with the objective of making quality education accessible, flexible, and industry-relevant for learners across different geographical regions. By integrating advanced technology with academic excellence, the company enables students to pursue recognized university degree programs without the constraints of traditional classroom learning.

The company functions as a comprehensive learning solutions provider by collaborating with reputed universities and offering online undergraduate, postgraduate, professional certification, and executive education programs. Through its technology-driven platform, UNext Learning provides an end-to-end educational ecosystem that includes student counselling, admissions, digital classrooms, learning management systems, assessments, learner support, academic mentoring, and career development services.

The rapid growth of internet accessibility, digital transformation, and changing learner preferences has significantly increased the demand for online education in India. Recognizing this opportunity, UNext Learning has positioned itself as a trusted educational partner for students seeking flexible learning options. The organization continuously focuses on enhancing the learner experience through innovation, personalized counselling, and technology-enabled academic support.

One of the major strengths of UNext Learning is its collaboration with prestigious universities under the Online Manipal platform. Through these partnerships, the company offers nationally recognized online degree programs that meet the educational needs of fresh graduates, working professionals, entrepreneurs, and lifelong learners. The platform ensures that students receive quality education, interactive learning experiences, and comprehensive academic support throughout their educational journey.

The company's operations are built upon a customer-centric approach, where understanding student aspirations and providing suitable educational guidance form the foundation of its business model. Admission counsellors play a crucial role in assisting prospective students by helping them identify suitable academic programs, clarifying eligibility criteria, explaining fee structures, resolving queries, and guiding them throughout the admission process. This approach not only improves student satisfaction but also contributes to higher admission conversion rates and long-term learner engagement.

In addition to academic services, UNext Learning actively invests in technological innovation, employee training, operational excellence, and quality assurance. The organization continuously upgrades its digital infrastructure and customer relationship management systems to improve operational efficiency and deliver seamless educational experiences.

During the internship, the researcher had the opportunity to observe various organizational activities, understand corporate workflows, interact with multiple departments, and gain practical exposure to the functioning of a rapidly growing Ed-Tech organization. This experience provided valuable insights into the business processes, organizational culture, customer relationship management practices, and strategic importance of technology in modern higher education.

Overall, UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. represents a significant contributor to India's digital education ecosystem by combining technology, academic excellence, and learner-centric services to create meaningful educational opportunities for students across the country.

2.2 Company Profile

The profile of an organization provides an overview of its identity, business operations, objectives, and market position. UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. has established itself as one of India's prominent Ed-Tech organizations by delivering technology-enabled higher education solutions in collaboration with leading universities.

The company specializes in providing online degree programs, executive education, professional certifications, and digital learning services. Its primary objective is to make quality higher education accessible to learners irrespective of their geographical location or professional commitments. Through

continuous technological innovation and learner-centric services, the company has successfully expanded its presence across India and serves thousands of students every year.

The organization's business model focuses on building long-term partnerships with reputed educational institutions while providing comprehensive admission support, student counselling, digital learning infrastructure, and academic assistance. This integrated approach ensures that learners receive a seamless educational experience from the initial inquiry stage until successful program completion.

Particular	Details
Company Name	UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.
Industry	Educational Technology (Ed-Tech)
Business Nature	Online Higher Education & Learning Solutions
Head Office	Bengaluru, Karnataka, India
Type of Organization	Private Limited Company
Business Model	Business-to-Consumer (B2C) and Business-to-Business (B2B)
Core Services	Online Degree Programs, Student Counselling, Admissions, Learning Management
Technology Platform	Online Manipal
Partner Universities	Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ), Sikkim Manipal University (SMU)
Target Customers	Students, Working Professionals, Entrepreneurs, Career Changers
Internship Role	Admission Officer (Education Counsellor)

2.3 History of the Company

The emergence of Educational Technology companies has revolutionized the way higher education is delivered worldwide. UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. was established with the vision of combining education and technology to create a flexible and accessible learning ecosystem capable of addressing the evolving educational needs of modern learners.

With increasing digital adoption and the growing demand for online education, the company recognized the need for a comprehensive platform that could connect reputed universities with students seeking quality education without geographical barriers. To achieve this objective,

UNext Learning invested significantly in digital infrastructure, learning technologies, student support services, and academic partnerships.

The company's growth accelerated through its collaboration with leading universities under the Online Manipal platform. These partnerships enabled the organization to offer recognized undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs while maintaining high academic standards and providing students with industry-oriented learning experiences.

Over the years, UNext Learning has continuously expanded its portfolio of academic programs, improved technological capabilities, strengthened learner support systems, and enhanced customer relationship management practices. The organization has successfully adapted to changing educational trends, especially following the increasing acceptance of online learning among students and working professionals.

Today, UNext Learning serves learners from diverse educational and professional backgrounds by offering flexible learning opportunities supported by experienced faculty members, interactive digital classrooms, modern learning management systems, and dedicated admission counselling services.

The company continues to focus on innovation, academic excellence, and learner success while contributing significantly to the digital transformation of India's higher education sector.

2.4 Vision

The vision of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. is to transform higher education by making quality learning accessible, affordable, flexible, and technology-driven for learners across the world.

The organization aims to become a globally recognized digital learning partner that empowers individuals through lifelong learning opportunities and contributes to the

development of skilled professionals capable of meeting the demands of the modern workforce.

The company's vision reflects its commitment to creating an inclusive educational ecosystem where students can pursue academic excellence regardless of geographical, professional, or personal constraints.

2.5 Mission

The mission of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. is to provide innovative and learner-centric educational solutions through advanced technology, strategic university partnerships, and comprehensive student support services.

The company strives to deliver high-quality online education by integrating academic excellence with digital innovation, ensuring that learners receive personalized guidance, flexible learning opportunities, and continuous academic assistance throughout their educational journey.

Its mission also emphasizes building strong relationships with students, universities, and industry partners while promoting continuous learning, employability, and professional development.

2.6 Core Values

Every successful organization operates on a strong foundation of core values that guide employee behavior, business decisions, and organizational culture. At UNext

Learning Pvt. Ltd., these values contribute significantly to delivering quality educational services and maintaining strong relationships with students and partner universities.

Student-Centric Approach

Students remain the primary focus of every organizational activity. The company strives to understand individual learner requirements and provide personalized counselling and academic support.

Integrity

The organization maintains honesty, transparency, and ethical business practices while interacting with students, universities, and employees.

Innovation

Continuous technological improvement and creative problem-solving enable the company to deliver modern educational solutions that enhance learner experiences.

Excellence

The company is committed to maintaining high standards in academic services, customer support, and operational efficiency.

Collaboration

Teamwork, mutual respect, and effective communication among departments contribute to achieving organizational goals and improving student satisfaction.

Continuous Learning

The organization encourages employees to continuously enhance their professional knowledge, technical skills, and leadership capabilities while adapting to changing industry trends.

2.7 Services Offered by UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. provides a comprehensive range of educational services designed to support learners throughout their academic journey. Rather than functioning solely as an online education platform, the organization offers integrated solutions that combine technology, academic excellence, student counselling, and learner support. Its services are structured to ensure that students receive continuous guidance from the stage of enquiry until the successful completion of their academic programs.

One of the primary services offered by the company is student admission counselling. Admission counsellors interact with prospective learners to understand their educational background, career aspirations, work experience, and personal interests. Based on this assessment, counsellors recommend suitable undergraduate or postgraduate programs that align with the learner's objectives. This personalized counselling process helps students make informed educational decisions.

The organization also provides admission assistance services, where students receive complete support throughout the admission process. This includes explaining eligibility criteria, assisting with online application forms, guiding students in document submission, clarifying fee payment procedures, and ensuring

successful enrollment into their chosen academic programs. By providing continuous assistance, the company simplifies the admission process and enhances the overall student experience.

Another important service is the Learning Management System (LMS), which acts as the digital classroom for students. Through this platform, learners can access recorded lectures, live online classes, e-books, assignments, quizzes, discussion forums, examination schedules, and academic announcements. The LMS enables students to learn at their own pace while maintaining continuous interaction with faculty members and academic mentors.

UNext Learning also offers academic support services to ensure that students receive guidance throughout their educational journey. Dedicated support teams assist learners in resolving academic queries, accessing study materials, attending online classes, completing assignments, and preparing for examinations. This continuous support improves student engagement and contributes to better learning outcomes.

Career development is another significant service provided by the organization. Students receive access to career guidance sessions, resume-building workshops, interview preparation programs, skill development activities, and placement assistance. These services help learners enhance their employability and prepare for professional opportunities after completing their degree programs.

The company also invests significantly in student relationship management through the use of Customer Relationship Management (CRM) systems. CRM technology

enables the organization to manage student enquiries, maintain communication records, schedule follow-ups, monitor admission progress, and ensure timely responses to learner queries. This technology-driven approach improves operational efficiency while maintaining a high level of customer satisfaction.

Furthermore, UNext Learning organizes regular webinars, faculty interaction sessions, orientation programs, and awareness campaigns to educate prospective students about online education and the career opportunities available through university degree programs. These initiatives strengthen student engagement and contribute to increased awareness regarding the benefits of flexible learning.

Through its integrated portfolio of educational services, UNext Learning has established itself as a learner-centric organization committed to delivering quality education supported by advanced technology, personalized counselling, and comprehensive student support.

2.8 Online Manipal Platform

The Online Manipal platform serves as the flagship digital learning ecosystem managed by UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. It has been developed to provide students with a seamless and technology-enabled educational experience while maintaining the academic standards of reputed universities. The platform acts as a centralized gateway through which learners can explore university programs, complete admissions, attend online classes, access learning resources, and interact with faculty members.

The primary objective of the Online Manipal platform is to make higher education more accessible and flexible for learners who may be unable to pursue traditional classroom education due to geographical, professional, or personal constraints. Through this platform, students can enroll in recognized undergraduate and postgraduate programs offered by partner universities without relocating or interrupting their careers.

The platform is designed with a user-friendly interface that simplifies every stage of the student journey. Prospective learners can browse available programs, compare course details, review eligibility criteria, understand fee structures, and interact with admission counsellors before making enrollment decisions. Once admitted, students receive secure access to their personalized learning dashboard.

The learning dashboard provides access to recorded video lectures, live interactive sessions, digital study materials, assignments, quizzes, internal assessments, discussion forums, examination schedules, and academic notifications. Students can monitor their learning progress, submit assignments online, communicate with faculty members, and receive academic support through a single integrated platform.

Another significant feature of the Online Manipal platform is its flexibility. Learners have the freedom to study according to their personal schedules while balancing professional and personal commitments. This flexibility has made online education particularly attractive to working professionals, entrepreneurs, homemakers, and individuals seeking career advancement.

The platform also incorporates modern technological features such as cloud-based learning infrastructure, secure digital examinations, automated progress tracking, online academic support, and integrated communication systems. These technological capabilities ensure that students receive a high-quality educational experience comparable to conventional classroom learning.

During the internship, the researcher observed that the Online Manipal platform played a central role in student counselling. Admission counsellors frequently demonstrated the platform to prospective students while explaining course structures, learning features, examination processes, and available support services. This practical exposure highlighted the importance of digital technology in enhancing student confidence and facilitating successful admissions.

Overall, the Online Manipal platform represents an innovative educational ecosystem that combines academic excellence, digital technology, and student-centric services to transform higher education delivery in India.

2.9 Partner Universities

A major strength of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. lies in its strategic collaboration with reputed universities that are recognized for their academic excellence and industry-oriented education. Through these partnerships, the company provides learners with access to high-quality online degree programs that meet national educational standards while offering the flexibility of digital learning.

2.9.1 Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)

Manipal Academy of Higher Education is one of India's premier private universities and is recognized for its commitment to academic excellence, research, innovation, and global education standards. The university offers a wide range of undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral programs across multiple disciplines.

Through the Online Manipal platform, MAHE provides online degree programs specifically designed for working professionals and students seeking flexible learning opportunities. These programs maintain rigorous academic standards while incorporating modern digital teaching methodologies. During the internship, the researcher counselled students regarding MAHE's online MBA, MCA, MSc, and other postgraduate programs, helping them understand eligibility requirements, curriculum structure, career opportunities, and admission procedures.

2.9.2 Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ)

Manipal University Jaipur is another prestigious institution partnered with UNext Learning. The university has earned recognition for offering industry-oriented education supported by experienced faculty members, modern curriculum, and technology-enabled learning environments.

MUJ offers a wide variety of online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs in Business Administration, Commerce, Computer Applications, Arts, Information Technology, and related disciplines. These programs are designed to develop professional competencies, leadership skills, and practical knowledge relevant to contemporary industries.

As part of the internship responsibilities, the researcher frequently interacted with prospective students interested in MUJ programs, explained course benefits, clarified fee structures, and guided applicants throughout the admission process.

2.9.3 Sikkim Manipal University (SMU)

Sikkim Manipal University has established itself as a respected institution providing quality higher education through flexible learning models. The university offers several online undergraduate and postgraduate programs aimed at students from diverse educational and professional backgrounds.

SMU emphasizes practical learning, industry relevance, and academic excellence while ensuring accessibility through digital education. Its online programs are particularly beneficial for working professionals seeking career advancement without interrupting their employment.

During the internship, the researcher counselled students interested in SMU's online degree programs, assisted them with admissions, answered academic queries, and coordinated documentation through the CRM system.

The collaboration between UNext Learning and these universities creates a comprehensive educational ecosystem that combines academic credibility, technological innovation, and personalized student support. This partnership enables learners to access recognized university degrees while benefiting from professional counselling and continuous academic assistance throughout their educational journey.

2.10 Organizational Structure

An organizational structure defines the hierarchy, roles, responsibilities, and reporting relationships within an organization. It facilitates effective communication, coordination, decision-making, and operational efficiency. UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. follows a well-defined organizational structure that enables different departments to work collaboratively toward achieving the company's strategic objectives.

The company operates under a hierarchical management system where top-level management is responsible for formulating organizational strategies, business expansion plans, and policy decisions. Middle-level managers supervise departmental operations, monitor employee performance, and ensure that organizational goals are achieved efficiently. Operational teams execute day-to-day activities related to admissions, student counselling, technology management, academic support, finance, human resources, and customer service.

During the internship, the researcher observed that continuous communication between departments played a crucial role in ensuring smooth admission processing and student satisfaction. Admission counsellors regularly coordinated with operations teams, documentation teams, finance departments, quality analysts, and technical support staff to ensure timely completion of admissions.

2.11 Departmental Functions

The efficient functioning of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. depends on the coordinated efforts of multiple departments. Each department performs specialized functions while contributing collectively to organizational success.

Human Resource Department

The Human Resource Department is responsible for recruitment, employee onboarding, training, performance management, payroll administration, employee engagement, and policy implementation. During the internship, HR professionals organized induction sessions and training programs that familiarized new employees with organizational processes, university programs, CRM software, and professional communication standards.

The department also focuses on developing employee competencies through continuous learning initiatives and performance evaluation systems.

Sales and Admission Department

The Sales and Admission Department serves as the core operational unit responsible for student counselling and admission management. Admission Officers interact with prospective learners, understand their educational requirements, recommend suitable academic programs, explain eligibility criteria, clarify fee structures, and guide students through the complete admission process.

The department continuously monitors admission targets, lead conversion rates, counselling quality, and customer satisfaction. Daily performance reports help managers evaluate employee productivity and identify opportunities for improvement.

During the internship, the researcher worked as an Admission Officer within this department and

gained practical experience in counselling, CRM handling, lead management, and admission processing.

Marketing Department

The Marketing Department promotes university programs through various digital and traditional marketing channels. It generates student enquiries using social media campaigns, search engine marketing, email marketing, webinars, educational events, and online advertisements.

The quality and quantity of student enquiries generated by the marketing team directly influence the performance of admission counsellors. Marketing professionals continuously analyze market trends, student preferences, and competitor strategies to improve campaign effectiveness.

Operations Department

The Operations Department ensures smooth execution of admission-related activities after students decide to enroll in a program. The department verifies application forms, checks supporting documents, coordinates with partner universities, monitors enrollment status, and resolves operational issues.

Efficient coordination between the Operations Department and Admission Counsellors is essential for ensuring timely admission completion.

Student Support Department

Student Support Executives assist learners after admission by resolving academic and technical issues. They provide guidance regarding online classes, Learning Management Systems (LMS), examinations, assignments, academic calendars, and university regulations.

The department contributes significantly to student satisfaction by ensuring continuous support

throughout the educational journey.

Information Technology Department

The Information Technology Department manages the technological infrastructure supporting Online Manipal. Its responsibilities include maintaining CRM software, Learning Management Systems, student portals, cybersecurity, database management, and technical troubleshooting.

Technology plays a critical role in delivering uninterrupted online learning experiences and maintaining efficient organizational operations.

Finance Department

The Finance Department manages fee collection, financial transactions, budgeting, accounting, invoice generation, and financial reporting. It ensures accurate processing of student fee payments and maintains financial transparency.

Admission counsellors frequently coordinate with finance executives while assisting students regarding payment options, installment facilities, and transaction confirmations.

2.12 Products and Programs Offered

UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., through the Online Manipal platform, offers a diverse portfolio of online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs designed to meet the educational needs of students, working professionals, entrepreneurs, and career changers.

The academic programs are structured to combine theoretical knowledge with practical applications while maintaining flexibility and accessibility.

Undergraduate Programs

The undergraduate programs offered through partner universities include:

- Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)
- Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com)
- Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA)
- Bachelor of Arts (BA)
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) (where applicable)

These programs are suitable for students seeking to build strong academic foundations while preparing for professional careers or higher education.

Postgraduate Programs

The postgraduate programs include:

- Master of Business Administration (MBA)
- Master of Computer Applications (MCA)
- Master of Commerce (M.Com)
- Master of Arts (MA)
- Master of Science (M.Sc.)

These programs are particularly popular among working professionals seeking career advancement, leadership positions, and specialized knowledge.

Professional Learning Features

Students enrolled through Online Manipal benefit from several educational features, including:

- Live online classes conducted by experienced faculty.
- Recorded lectures for flexible learning.
- Digital study materials and e-books.
- Online examinations and assessments.
- Discussion forums and collaborative learning.
- Academic mentoring.
- Placement assistance and career guidance.
- Industry-oriented curriculum.
- University-recognized degree upon successful completion.

These features make online education highly flexible while maintaining academic quality comparable to traditional learning environments.

2.13 SWOT Analysis of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

A SWOT Analysis evaluates an organization's internal strengths and weaknesses along with external opportunities and threats. It provides strategic insights into organizational performance and future growth potential.

Strengths

- Strong partnerships with reputed universities such as MAHE, MUJ, and SMU.
- Established Online Manipal digital learning platform.
- Comprehensive admission counselling and learner support.
- Experienced faculty and academic mentors.
- Flexible online learning model suitable for working professionals.
- Advanced CRM systems supporting efficient lead management.
- Strong brand recognition in the Ed-Tech industry.

Weaknesses

- Dependence on internet connectivity for uninterrupted learning.
- Student skepticism regarding online education in certain regions.

- Intense competition within the Ed-Tech market.
- Admission conversion depends heavily on counsellor performance.
- High expectations for continuous technological improvements.

Opportunities

- Rapid growth of India's online education market.
- Increasing acceptance of online university degrees.
- Expansion into international education markets.
- Growing demand for upskilling and lifelong learning.
- Technological advancements including Artificial Intelligence and adaptive learning systems.
- Government support for digital education initiatives.

Threats

- Increasing competition from established Ed-Tech companies.
- Frequent technological changes requiring continuous investment.
- Changing educational regulations and accreditation policies.
- Economic fluctuations affecting students' affordability.
- Cybersecurity risks associated with digital education platforms.

The SWOT Analysis indicates that UNext Learning possesses significant competitive strengths while also facing challenges common to rapidly evolving technology-driven industries.

2.14 Chapter Summary

This chapter presented a comprehensive overview of UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., including its organizational background, services, digital learning platform, university partnerships, organizational structure, departmental functions, academic offerings, and strategic position within the Indian Ed-Tech industry.

The discussion highlighted the company's commitment to providing accessible, flexible, and technology-enabled higher education through strong collaborations with prestigious universities.

It also demonstrated how various organizational departments work together to ensure effective student counselling, efficient admission management, and high levels of learner satisfaction.

Furthermore, the chapter explained the role of the researcher as an Admission Officer and illustrated how organizational processes support student engagement from initial enquiry to successful enrollment. The SWOT analysis provided an understanding of the company's competitive strengths, growth opportunities, operational challenges, and external business environment.

Overall, this chapter establishes a strong organizational foundation for the subsequent analysis of the Ed-Tech sector and benchmarking practices presented in the next chapter.

CHAPTER 3

SECTORAL ANALYSIS AND BENCHMARKING WITH OTHER COMPANIES & MARKET ANALYSIS OF THE PRODUCT/SERVICE

3.1 Introduction

The Education Technology (Ed-Tech) sector has emerged as one of the fastest-growing industries in the global economy. The integration of digital technologies with education has transformed the way knowledge is delivered, accessed, and consumed. Traditional classroom-based learning is gradually being complemented by technology-enabled education that provides learners with flexibility, accessibility, and personalized learning experiences. The rapid adoption of smartphones, high-speed internet, cloud computing, and artificial intelligence has significantly accelerated the growth of online education across the world.

In India, the Ed-Tech industry has witnessed remarkable expansion over the last decade. The increasing demand for skill-based education, career advancement opportunities, professional certifications, and flexible higher education has encouraged educational institutions and technology companies to develop innovative digital learning solutions. The acceptance of online degree programs has further strengthened after regulatory approvals from higher education authorities and the increasing recognition of online qualifications by employers.

UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. operates within this dynamic and competitive environment by providing technology-enabled higher education services through the **Online Manipal** platform. The organization collaborates with reputed universities to offer recognized undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs supported by comprehensive student counselling, admission assistance, digital learning infrastructure, and academic support services.

The purpose of this chapter is to analyze the Ed-Tech sector, examine the competitive environment, compare UNext Learning with major industry players, and evaluate the company's products and services within the broader online education market.

3.2 Overview of the Indian Ed-Tech Industry

The Indian Education Technology industry has become one of the most rapidly evolving sectors due to increasing internet penetration, digital transformation, government initiatives promoting online education, and changing learner preferences. Online education has moved beyond short-term certification programs and now includes complete undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs delivered through digital learning platforms.

Several factors have contributed to the growth of the Indian Ed-Tech industry. The widespread availability of affordable smartphones, improved internet connectivity, increasing digital literacy, and the growing number of working professionals seeking flexible education have significantly expanded the

market. Additionally, organizations increasingly value continuous learning and professional development, encouraging employees to pursue higher education while remaining employed.

The introduction of modern Learning Management Systems (LMS), cloud computing, artificial intelligence, virtual classrooms, and digital assessment platforms has improved the overall learning experience. Students can now attend live classes, access recorded lectures, complete assignments, participate in discussions, and appear for examinations through secure online platforms without geographical limitations.

The Indian government has also played a crucial role in promoting digital education through initiatives such as Digital India, SWAYAM, the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, and regulations issued by the University Grants Commission (UGC) supporting online degree programs. These initiatives have increased public confidence in online higher education while encouraging universities to expand their digital offerings.

As competition within the industry continues to increase, organizations differentiate themselves through technology, academic partnerships, learner support services, placement assistance, and personalized counselling. Companies such as UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. focus on delivering complete educational ecosystems rather than merely providing digital content.

3.3 Growth of Online Higher Education in India

The online higher education sector has experienced unprecedented growth due to changing educational requirements and technological advancements. Earlier, online education was primarily associated with short-term certification programs. However, the acceptance of fully online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs has transformed the educational landscape.

Working professionals constitute one of the largest segments of online learners because flexible education allows them to continue their employment while enhancing their qualifications. Similarly, students residing in rural and semi-urban regions can now access quality education offered by reputed universities without relocating to metropolitan cities.

The increasing demand for management, commerce, computer applications, information technology, and healthcare programs has further contributed to the expansion of online education. Universities have responded by introducing industry-relevant curricula, interactive digital classrooms, recorded lectures, online examinations, and virtual student support services.

Online higher education also offers financial advantages compared to conventional campus-based education. Students save on accommodation, transportation, and relocation expenses while receiving comparable academic qualifications recognized by employers and regulatory authorities.

As awareness regarding online education continues to increase, the sector is expected to experience sustained long-term growth supported by technological innovation, government policies, and changing workforce requirements.

3.4 Market Trends in the Ed-Tech Industry

The Ed-Tech industry is continuously evolving in response to technological advancements and learner expectations. Several emerging trends are shaping the future of online higher education and influencing organizational strategies.

One significant trend is the increasing use of Artificial Intelligence to personalize learning experiences. AI-powered platforms analyze learner behavior, recommend study materials, monitor academic progress, and provide intelligent academic assistance.

Another important trend is mobile-first learning. Most students now access educational content using smartphones and tablets, encouraging organizations to optimize digital platforms for mobile devices.

Interactive learning has become increasingly popular through live virtual classrooms, discussion forums, peer collaboration, gamification, and simulation-based education. These features improve student engagement and learning outcomes compared to traditional passive learning methods.

Industry collaboration has also become an important trend. Universities increasingly collaborate with corporate organizations to develop curricula aligned with current industry requirements. This ensures that graduates possess relevant professional competencies and employability skills.

Another growing trend is the increasing demand for lifelong learning. Professionals continuously upgrade their knowledge through online degree programs, executive education, and specialized certifications to remain competitive in rapidly changing industries.

Organizations that successfully integrate these technological and educational trends are expected to maintain a strong competitive position within the rapidly evolving Ed-Tech ecosystem.

3.5 Market Size and Future Opportunities

India possesses one of the world's largest higher education systems, creating enormous opportunities for the Ed-Tech industry. Millions of students graduate annually from schools and colleges while a significant proportion of working professionals seek additional qualifications to improve their career prospects.

The increasing adoption of digital technologies, expansion of internet connectivity, rising smartphone penetration, and growing acceptance of online learning continue to expand the potential customer base for Ed-Tech organizations.

Future growth opportunities exist in several areas, including:

- Expansion of online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs.
- Corporate upskilling and executive education.
- International student enrollment.
- Artificial Intelligence-powered personalized learning.

- Skill-based professional certification programs.
- Regional language digital education.
- Industry-integrated curriculum development.
- Hybrid learning models combining online and offline education.
- Virtual laboratories and simulation-based learning.
- Career development and placement support services.

Organizations that continuously innovate while maintaining academic quality and strong student support systems are expected to achieve sustainable long-term growth.

CHAPTER 4

INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

4.1 Introduction to the Industry

The education sector is one of the most important contributors to the social and economic development of a nation. In recent years, technological advancements have significantly transformed the traditional education system, leading to the emergence of the Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) industry. Ed-Tech refers to the integration of digital technology with education to improve teaching, learning, assessment, and student engagement. It enables learners to access quality education through online platforms, virtual classrooms, mobile applications, and digital learning management systems.

The Indian Ed-Tech industry has experienced remarkable growth over the past decade due to increased internet penetration, smartphone adoption, government initiatives promoting digital education, and the growing demand for flexible learning opportunities. Unlike conventional classroom education, online learning allows students to pursue academic programs regardless of their geographical location or professional commitments.

Educational institutions and technology companies have collaborated to develop innovative digital learning ecosystems that provide university degree programs, professional certifications, executive education, and skill-development courses. Companies such as UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. have become key contributors to this transformation by partnering with reputed universities and delivering technology-enabled higher education through platforms like Online Manipal.

The industry has also responded to the changing expectations of modern learners. Today's students seek personalized learning experiences, flexible schedules, career-oriented curriculum, and continuous academic support. Consequently, Ed-Tech organizations focus on providing comprehensive educational solutions that combine technology, counselling, academic mentoring, and career guidance.

As digital education continues to gain acceptance among students, working professionals, and employers, the Ed-Tech industry is expected to remain one of the fastest-growing sectors in India. Understanding this industry's characteristics, opportunities, challenges, and competitive environment is therefore essential for evaluating the role of organizations such as UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

4.2 Evolution of the Ed-Tech Industry in India

The concept of technology-enabled education in India has evolved gradually over several decades. Initially, educational technology was limited to computer-based learning, television broadcasts, and correspondence education. However, rapid technological developments, increased internet accessibility, and widespread smartphone usage transformed the education sector into a digitally connected ecosystem.

The growth of cloud computing, video conferencing technologies, Learning Management Systems (LMS), and mobile applications enabled educational institutions to offer interactive online learning experiences. Students gained access to live lectures, recorded classes, digital libraries, assignments, discussion forums, and online examinations through integrated digital platforms.

The COVID-19 pandemic further accelerated the adoption of online education by forcing educational institutions to shift from traditional classroom teaching to virtual learning environments. Universities, colleges, schools, and training institutes invested heavily in digital infrastructure, making online education a mainstream mode of learning rather than an alternative option.

Following the pandemic, learners became more comfortable with online education due to its flexibility, affordability, and accessibility. Government regulatory bodies such as the University Grants Commission (UGC) also introduced guidelines supporting online degree programs offered by recognized universities. This regulatory support strengthened public confidence in online higher education and encouraged further industry growth.

Today, the Indian Ed-Tech industry includes university degree programs, executive education, certification courses, competitive examination preparation, school education, language learning, corporate training, and skill development. Organizations continuously invest in artificial intelligence, virtual reality, adaptive learning systems, and data analytics to improve educational outcomes and learner engagement.

4.3 Characteristics of the Ed-Tech Industry

The Ed-Tech industry possesses several unique characteristics that differentiate it from traditional educational institutions.

Firstly, it is highly technology-driven. Digital platforms, cloud computing, artificial intelligence, mobile applications, and learning management systems form the foundation of educational service delivery. Technology enables organizations to provide high-quality education to learners across different geographical locations.

Secondly, the industry is learner-centric. Educational services are designed according to student requirements, career aspirations, learning preferences, and professional commitments. Flexible learning schedules and personalized academic support enhance the overall learner experience.

Another important characteristic is scalability. Unlike conventional classroom education, digital platforms can simultaneously serve thousands of learners without requiring significant physical infrastructure. This allows organizations to expand rapidly while maintaining operational efficiency.

The industry is also highly competitive, with numerous companies offering similar educational services. Organizations differentiate themselves through university partnerships, technological innovation, faculty quality, learner support, placement assistance, and student counselling services.

Continuous innovation is another defining characteristic. Companies regularly upgrade digital platforms, introduce new learning technologies, improve course content, and develop advanced student engagement strategies to remain competitive.

Finally, regulatory compliance plays a crucial role in the Ed-Tech industry. Organizations must comply with educational regulations, accreditation standards, data privacy laws, and quality assurance requirements to maintain credibility and public trust.

4.4 Drivers of Industry Growth

Several factors have contributed to the rapid growth of the Indian Ed-Tech industry.

One of the primary drivers is the increasing penetration of smartphones and affordable internet services. These technological developments have enabled millions of students to access online educational resources from their homes.

Changing employment patterns have also increased demand for continuous learning and professional development. Many working professionals pursue online degree programs to improve their qualifications without interrupting their careers.

Government initiatives such as Digital India, Skill India, National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, and SWAYAM have encouraged digital learning and expanded educational accessibility throughout the country.

Another important growth driver is the increasing recognition of online degrees by employers. Organizations now value practical skills, continuous learning, and professional certifications alongside traditional educational qualifications.

Technological advancements including artificial intelligence, cloud computing, big data analytics, and virtual learning environments have further enhanced the effectiveness and attractiveness of online education.

Additionally, the growing need for affordable higher education has encouraged students to choose online programs that eliminate expenses related to accommodation, transportation, and relocation.

4.5 PESTLE Analysis of the Ed-Tech Industry

PESTLE Analysis is a strategic management tool used to evaluate the external macro-environment affecting an industry.

Political Factors

Government policies promoting digital education, higher education reforms, and investments in digital infrastructure positively influence the Ed-Tech industry. Regulatory support from the University Grants Commission (UGC) and initiatives such as Digital India encourage industry expansion.

Economic Factors

Increasing disposable incomes, economic growth, and demand for skilled professionals create opportunities for online education providers. However, economic slowdowns may affect students' ability to invest in higher education.

Social Factors

Growing awareness regarding lifelong learning, career advancement, and flexible education has significantly increased the acceptance of online learning. Working professionals, homemakers, and rural students increasingly prefer digital education due to its convenience.

Technological Factors

Technological innovation remains the strongest driver of industry growth. Artificial Intelligence, Learning Management Systems, cloud computing, data analytics, virtual classrooms, and mobile applications continuously improve educational quality and operational efficiency.

Legal Factors

Educational institutions must comply with regulations established by the University Grants Commission, data privacy legislation, copyright laws, and quality assurance standards while delivering online education.

Environmental Factors

Online education contributes positively to environmental sustainability by reducing paper consumption, transportation requirements, and physical infrastructure usage, thereby lowering carbon emissions associated with traditional educational systems.

4.6 Porter's Five Forces Analysis

Porter's Five Forces framework helps evaluate the competitive intensity within the Ed-Tech industry.

Threat of New Entrants – High

The rapid growth of online education has attracted numerous startups and educational organizations. Although technology development requires investment, new companies can enter the market relatively easily through digital platforms.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers – Moderate

Universities, faculty members, technology providers, and software developers serve as key suppliers. Strong university partnerships significantly influence organizational competitiveness.

Bargaining Power of Buyers – High

Students have numerous alternatives when selecting online educational platforms. Therefore, organizations must provide superior counselling, affordable pricing, academic quality, and excellent learner support to attract and retain students.

Threat of Substitute Services – Moderate

Traditional classroom education, hybrid learning models, corporate training programs, and international online education platforms provide alternative learning opportunities.

Competitive Rivalry – Very High

Competition among Ed-Tech companies is intense due to continuous technological innovation, aggressive marketing strategies, university collaborations, pricing competition, and expanding course portfolios.

CHAPTER - 5

JOB DESCRIPTION & VALUE ADDITION OF THE INTERN TO SOLVE THE COMPANY PROBLEMS / IMPROVE EXISTING WORK

5.1 Introduction

An internship provides students with an opportunity to understand how business operations are carried out in a real corporate environment. It enables them to apply theoretical concepts acquired during their academic program while simultaneously developing practical knowledge, professional skills, and industry exposure. During the internship period at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., the researcher worked as an Admission Officer (Education Counsellor) within the Admissions Department.

The primary responsibility of this role was to guide prospective students interested in pursuing online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs offered through the Online Manipal platform. The internship involved interacting with students from diverse educational, professional, and geographical backgrounds. Every counselling session required understanding the student's academic qualifications, career aspirations, financial considerations, and learning preferences before recommending a suitable academic program.

Apart from student counselling, the internship included handling admission enquiries, managing customer relationship management (CRM) software, maintaining student records, conducting follow-up activities, assisting with document verification, coordinating with internal departments, and ensuring successful completion of admissions. These responsibilities provided practical exposure to sales management, customer relationship management, communication strategies, operational coordination, and performance management.

The internship also enabled the researcher to understand the importance of professional ethics, teamwork, time management, customer satisfaction, and continuous learning within a dynamic Ed-Tech organization. This chapter discusses the responsibilities performed, work processes followed, challenges encountered, and value added to the organization during the internship period.

5.2 Internship Profile

The internship was completed at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., one of India's leading Educational Technology companies. The organization collaborates with reputed universities to deliver online degree programs through the Online Manipal platform.

The researcher worked in the Admissions Department under the guidance of the reporting manager and team leaders. The position involved direct interaction with prospective students seeking admission into online degree programs offered by Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ), and Sikkim Manipal University (SMU).

Internship Detail :

Particular	Details
Company Name	UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.
Industry	Educational Technology (Ed-Tech)
Department	Admissions
Internship Role	Admission Officer (Education Counsellor)
Internship Duration	Six Months
Reporting To	Team Leader / Assistant Manager
Working Mode	Full-Time Corporate Internship
Location	Bengaluru, Karnataka

The internship focused primarily on student counselling, admission management, customer relationship management, and lead conversion activities.

5.3 Roles and Responsibilities

As an Admission Officer, the researcher performed several operational and customer-facing responsibilities that contributed to the organization's admission process. The role required continuous interaction with prospective students while ensuring high standards of professionalism, accuracy, and customer satisfaction.

The major responsibilities included:

Student Counselling

The primary responsibility was to counsel prospective students regarding various online undergraduate and postgraduate degree programs. Counselling involved understanding students' educational

backgrounds, career objectives, work experience, and future aspirations before recommending suitable programs.

Explaining University Programs

Students were provided detailed information regarding programs offered by MAHE, MUJ, and SMU. This included explaining course curriculum, specialization options, eligibility criteria, fee structures, program duration, examination patterns, learning methodology, and career opportunities after graduation.

Admission Guidance

The researcher guided students through every stage of the admission process. This included explaining application procedures, assisting with online registration, document submission, fee payment, and enrollment confirmation.

Lead Management

Student enquiries received through marketing campaigns were assigned through CRM software. Each lead required timely follow-up, personalized counselling, and continuous communication until the admission process was completed.

Customer Relationship Management

CRM software was used to update student information, record counselling interactions, schedule follow-up activities, monitor admission status, and generate daily productivity reports.

Maintaining accurate CRM records ensured effective communication and improved admission conversion rates.

Follow-up Communication

Regular follow-up with interested students formed a major part of daily responsibilities. Follow-up activities included telephone conversations, WhatsApp communication, email correspondence, and reminder calls regarding documentation and fee payment.

Target Achievement

Admission Officers were assigned daily and monthly counselling targets. Performance was evaluated based on the number of student interactions, follow-up completion, admissions achieved, conversion ratios, and customer satisfaction.

Coordination with Internal Departments

Successful admission processing required continuous coordination with Operations, Finance, Documentation, Student Support, and Quality Assurance teams. Effective teamwork ensured timely completion of student admissions.

5.4 Daily Work Activities

During the internship, daily activities followed a structured workflow designed to ensure efficient handling of student enquiries and admission processes.

The workday typically began by logging into the CRM system and reviewing newly assigned student enquiries. Each enquiry was carefully analyzed before initiating communication with prospective students.

The first interaction involved understanding the student's educational qualifications, career objectives, employment status, preferred course, and future aspirations. Based on this assessment, appropriate university programs were recommended.

Following the initial counselling session, students received detailed information regarding eligibility requirements, admission procedures, documentation, fee structures, scholarships (where applicable), examination patterns, and learning methodologies.

Students requiring additional clarification were contacted through scheduled follow-up calls, WhatsApp messages, or email communication. Continuous follow-up ensured that prospective students remained engaged throughout the admission process.

Throughout the day, CRM records were updated after every interaction. Accurate documentation enabled effective tracking of admission progress while facilitating coordination with other organizational departments.

The workday concluded by reviewing pending admissions, updating productivity reports, planning future follow-ups, and discussing operational issues with team leaders during daily review meetings.

5.5 Admission Process Followed at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd.

The admission process followed by UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. consists of multiple stages that ensure efficient enrollment while maintaining academic and regulatory compliance

CHAPTER-6

LEARNING OUTCOMES FROM THE INTERNSHIP

6.1 Introduction

An internship is an integral component of management education as it enables students to apply theoretical concepts in a practical business environment. While classroom learning provides knowledge of management principles, internships help students understand how these concepts are implemented within organizations. The practical exposure gained through internships develops professional competence, decision-making ability, communication skills, and industry awareness.

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. provided an opportunity to work in the rapidly growing Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) sector. Serving as an Admission Officer (Education Counsellor) allowed the researcher to gain first-hand experience in student counselling, admission management, customer relationship management, lead conversion, and organizational coordination. The internship involved continuous interaction with prospective students, collaboration with internal departments, and the use of digital tools to support the admission process.

Throughout the internship period, the researcher was able to bridge the gap between academic learning and corporate practice. The experience enhanced technical knowledge, interpersonal abilities, analytical thinking, and professional confidence. This chapter discusses the major learning outcomes achieved during the internship and explains how the experience contributed to the overall professional development of the researcher.

6.2 Professional Learning Outcomes

One of the most valuable outcomes of the internship was gaining an understanding of professional work culture and corporate expectations. Working in a structured organizational environment helped the researcher appreciate the importance of discipline, accountability, punctuality, teamwork, and ethical conduct.

The internship also highlighted the significance of maintaining professionalism while interacting with students, colleagues, and managers. Every communication required clarity, patience, respect, and empathy. Learning to handle different personalities and situations improved the researcher's confidence and ability to build positive relationships with customers.

The experience also provided exposure to target-oriented work environments where performance was regularly monitored through counselling quality, lead conversion, productivity, and customer satisfaction. This developed a stronger sense of responsibility and commitment toward achieving organizational objectives.

6.3 Technical Learning Outcomes

The internship provided practical exposure to various technological tools and digital platforms used within the Ed-Tech industry.

One of the key technical learnings was the use of Customer Relationship Management (CRM) software. The researcher learned how to record student information, update enquiry status, schedule follow-up activities, maintain communication history, and monitor admission progress. Proper use of CRM improved organizational efficiency while ensuring that prospective students received timely guidance.

The researcher also gained familiarity with the Online Manipal platform, including the process of explaining digital learning features, online classrooms, examination procedures, student dashboards, and academic support services to prospective learners.

In addition, the internship improved proficiency in using Microsoft Office applications, online communication platforms, email correspondence, and digital documentation systems that support day-to-day business operations.

6.4 Communication and Counselling Skills

Communication formed the foundation of the internship experience. As an Admission Officer, the researcher interacted daily with prospective students from different educational, professional, and cultural backgrounds.

The internship significantly improved verbal communication skills by providing continuous opportunities to explain university programs, resolve student queries, discuss career opportunities, and guide applicants through the admission process.

The researcher also developed active listening skills by carefully understanding each student's educational qualifications, career aspirations, financial considerations, and personal circumstances before recommending appropriate academic programs.

Counselling required not only providing information but also building trust and confidence among prospective learners. The ability to communicate clearly, confidently, and professionally contributed significantly to successful student engagement and improved admission conversion.

6.5 Customer Relationship Management Skills

The internship emphasized the importance of building and maintaining strong relationships with students throughout the admission journey.

The researcher learned that effective customer relationship management extends beyond initial communication. Continuous follow-up, timely responses, personalized guidance, and proactive problem-solving play a crucial role in improving student satisfaction and organizational reputation.

The practical use of CRM software reinforced the importance of maintaining accurate

records, documenting every interaction, scheduling reminders, and tracking student progress. These practices helped improve communication efficiency and supported better decision-making.

Understanding customer needs and delivering personalized educational solutions became one of the most significant professional competencies developed during the internship.

6.6 Sales and Admission Management Learning

Although the primary objective was educational counselling, the internship also provided practical exposure to sales management concepts.

The researcher learned that admission counselling combines consultative selling with customer service. Rather than promoting courses aggressively, the focus remained on understanding student requirements and recommending programs that genuinely matched their academic and career goals.

The internship improved understanding of the complete admission lifecycle, including enquiry generation, lead qualification, counselling, objection handling, document verification, fee payment, admission confirmation, and student enrollment.

Learning how to manage multiple student enquiries simultaneously while maintaining service quality significantly improved organizational and multitasking abilities.

6.7 Application of MBA Concepts

One of the major objectives of the internship was to apply classroom learning in a practical business environment.

Several MBA subjects were directly relevant to the responsibilities performed during the internship.

Marketing Management

Marketing concepts were applied while understanding student needs, positioning university programs, explaining program benefits, and improving admission conversion through effective communication.

Business Communication

The internship strengthened written and verbal communication through telephone conversations, email correspondence, WhatsApp communication, and professional interactions with students and colleagues.

Organizational Behaviour

Working within a multidisciplinary team improved understanding of teamwork, leadership, workplace ethics, motivation, conflict management, and organizational culture.

Human Resource Management

The internship provided practical insights into employee training, performance evaluation, workplace discipline, and professional development.

Business Analytics

CRM reports, productivity dashboards, and lead conversion statistics helped the researcher understand how business data supports managerial decision-making and performance improvement.

The internship successfully demonstrated how theoretical management concepts can be applied to solve real organizational challenges.

6.8 Personal Development

In addition to professional competencies, the internship contributed significantly to the researcher's personal growth.

Regular interaction with prospective students improved self-confidence, public speaking ability, emotional intelligence, and decision-making skills. Managing daily responsibilities under performance targets strengthened time management and prioritization skills.

The researcher also developed greater adaptability by learning to handle changing student requirements, evolving organizational priorities, and challenging counselling situations.

The internship encouraged continuous learning, self-improvement, and a proactive approach toward professional development.

6.9 Overall Learning Experience

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. provided a comprehensive understanding of the functioning of an Ed-Tech organization and the importance of student counselling in online higher education.

The researcher gained practical exposure to customer relationship management, sales processes, digital learning platforms, organizational coordination, and technology-enabled education. The experience enhanced communication abilities, technical competencies, teamwork, and leadership qualities while strengthening confidence in handling professional responsibilities.

The internship also demonstrated the value of empathy, ethical conduct, and student-centric service in building long-term organizational success. The combination of academic learning and practical experience has prepared the researcher for future managerial roles in the education and corporate sectors.

6.10 Chapter Summary

This chapter presented the major learning outcomes achieved during the internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. It highlighted the professional, technical, and interpersonal competencies developed while working as an Admission Officer. The discussion demonstrated how classroom concepts from the MBA program were effectively applied in a real corporate environment. The internship enhanced communication skills, counselling abilities, customer relationship management, sales understanding, teamwork, and technological proficiency. It also strengthened analytical thinking, problem-solving, adaptability, and professional confidence.

Overall, the internship served as a valuable learning experience that bridged the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application. It contributed significantly to the researcher's academic development, career readiness, and understanding of the rapidly evolving Ed-Tech industry.

CHAPTER - 7

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

7.1 Introduction

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. provided an excellent opportunity to gain practical exposure to the functioning of the Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) industry. It served as an important bridge between the theoretical knowledge acquired during the MBA program and its practical application within a professional corporate environment. The experience enabled the researcher to understand the operational processes involved in student counselling, admission management, customer relationship management, and digital education services.

Working as an Admission Officer (Education Counsellor) allowed the researcher to interact with students from diverse educational and professional backgrounds. These interactions enhanced communication skills, problem-solving abilities, analytical thinking, and interpersonal competence while providing valuable insights into the growing online higher education sector. The internship also strengthened professional confidence by allowing the researcher to independently handle student enquiries, admission procedures, CRM operations, and coordination with multiple organizational departments.

This chapter summarizes the overall findings of the internship, presents recommendations for organizational improvement, highlights the limitations of the study, and reflects upon the contribution of the internship towards personal and professional development.

7.2 Major Findings of the Study

The internship generated several valuable observations regarding student counselling, admission management, and organizational functioning within the Ed-Tech industry.

One of the major findings was that effective student counselling significantly influences admission decisions. Prospective students often require detailed guidance before selecting an academic program. Counsellors who understand student aspirations and provide personalized recommendations contribute substantially to successful admissions.

The study also found that Customer Relationship Management (CRM) systems play a crucial role in admission management. Proper utilization of CRM software enables counsellors to monitor student enquiries, maintain communication records, schedule follow-ups, and improve admission conversion rates. Accurate CRM data also assists managers in evaluating employee performance and operational efficiency.

Another important observation was that continuous follow-up communication increases student engagement and enrollment. Many students require multiple interactions before making admission decisions. Consistent communication through telephone calls, emails, and WhatsApp helps build trust and strengthens the relationship between the organization and prospective learners.

The internship also demonstrated the importance of teamwork and interdepartmental coordination. Successful admission completion depends upon effective collaboration between admission counsellors, operations teams, finance departments, documentation teams, quality analysts, and student support executives.

The study further highlighted the growing acceptance of online higher education among working professionals and recent graduates. Students increasingly prefer flexible learning models that allow them to balance education with employment and personal responsibilities. This trend creates significant growth opportunities for organizations operating within the Ed-Tech industry.

Finally, the internship confirmed that continuous employee training, product knowledge, communication skills, and technological competence are essential for delivering high-quality student counselling services and maintaining organizational competitiveness.

7.3 Recommendations

Based on the observations made during the internship, the following recommendations may contribute to improving organizational performance and student satisfaction.

Strengthen Continuous Employee Training

Regular training programs should be conducted to enhance counsellors' knowledge regarding university programs, admission policies, industry trends, counselling techniques, and communication strategies. Continuous learning enables employees to provide more accurate and effective guidance to prospective students.

Enhance CRM Capabilities

The organization may further strengthen its Customer Relationship Management system by integrating intelligent automation, predictive analytics, and personalized communication features. These improvements would enable more efficient lead management and improve operational productivity.

Increase Student Awareness Programs

The company should organize more webinars, virtual seminars, educational workshops, and career guidance sessions to increase awareness regarding online higher education. These initiatives can help address misconceptions about online degrees and improve student confidence.

Improve Personalized Counselling

Although standardized admission procedures are necessary, counselling should remain personalized according to each student's educational background, career objectives, financial capacity, and professional aspirations. Personalized counselling improves customer satisfaction and increases admission conversion rates.

Strengthen Career Support Services

Expanding placement assistance, resume-building workshops, interview preparation programs, and industry networking opportunities would further enhance the value proposition offered to students and improve graduate employability.

Expand Industry Collaborations

Developing additional collaborations with industries and corporate organizations can strengthen curriculum relevance, create internship opportunities, and improve placement outcomes for students.

Leverage Emerging Technologies

The organization should continue investing in Artificial Intelligence, data analytics, adaptive learning systems, and intelligent student support solutions to enhance operational efficiency and improve learner engagement.

7.4 Contribution of the Internship to the Researcher

The internship contributed significantly to the academic, professional, and personal development of the researcher.

Academically, it enabled the practical application of management concepts studied during the MBA program, including Marketing Management, Organizational Behaviour, Human Resource Management, Business Communication, Customer Relationship Management, and Business Analytics.

Professionally, the internship improved communication skills, counselling techniques, customer relationship management, negotiation abilities, teamwork, time management, and organizational discipline. The researcher gained confidence in handling real-world business situations while working in a target-oriented corporate environment.

Personally, the internship enhanced self-confidence, emotional intelligence, adaptability, leadership qualities, and decision-making ability. Daily interaction with students from diverse backgrounds improved interpersonal competence and strengthened the ability to work under pressure while maintaining professionalism.

Overall, the internship successfully prepared the researcher for future managerial

responsibilities by providing valuable industry exposure and practical learning experiences.

7.5 Scope for Future Research

The present study focuses specifically on student counselling and admission management at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. Future researchers may extend this work in several directions.

Comparative studies may be conducted to evaluate admission management practices across different Ed-Tech organizations operating in India.

Researchers may also examine the impact of Artificial Intelligence and machine learning on student counselling, personalized learning, and admission management.

Further studies may analyze student satisfaction, learning outcomes, placement performance, or long-term career development among graduates of online higher education programs.

Another potential area of research involves evaluating the effectiveness of digital learning platforms in improving academic performance and learner engagement compared with conventional classroom education.

These research directions would contribute to a broader understanding of the rapidly evolving online higher education ecosystem.

7.6 Overall Conclusion

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. was a valuable and enriching learning experience that successfully bridged the gap between academic knowledge and practical corporate exposure. Working in the Admissions Department provided comprehensive insights into the operational processes of an Ed-Tech organization, including student counselling, customer relationship management, admission processing, digital learning support, and organizational coordination.

The internship demonstrated that effective communication, empathy, product knowledge, technological competence, and teamwork are essential for achieving organizational objectives while maintaining high levels of student satisfaction. The practical application of MBA concepts significantly enhanced the researcher's understanding of modern business operations and strengthened managerial competencies.

The experience also highlighted the growing importance of online higher education in India's educational landscape. Technology-enabled learning platforms have expanded educational accessibility, providing learners with flexible and affordable opportunities to pursue recognized university degree programs.

Overall, the internship has contributed substantially to the researcher's professional confidence, career readiness, and understanding of the Ed-Tech industry. The knowledge and skills acquired during this period will serve as a strong foundation for future managerial roles and continuous professional development.

7.7 Chapter Summary

This chapter presented the overall conclusions drawn from the internship study and summarized the practical learning experience gained at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. It discussed the major findings related to student counselling, admission management, CRM utilization, teamwork, and organizational practices. The chapter also provided recommendations for enhancing operational effectiveness and student satisfaction.

Furthermore, it highlighted the internship's contribution to the researcher's academic learning, professional growth, and personal development while identifying opportunities for future research in the field of online higher education.

The internship successfully fulfilled its objective of integrating classroom learning with real-world corporate experience and provided valuable insights into the functioning of the rapidly expanding Ed-Tech industry.

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Annexure 1

BLOG

Link:

The Growing Importance of Student Counselling in Online Higher Education

Introduction

The education sector has undergone a remarkable transformation over the last decade, with digital technology making learning more accessible than ever before. Online higher education has become an increasingly preferred choice among students and working professionals due to its flexibility, affordability, and convenience. Universities now offer recognized undergraduate and postgraduate programs through digital platforms, allowing learners to pursue quality education without relocating or leaving their jobs.

However, despite the availability of numerous online programs, many students face challenges while selecting the right course, understanding eligibility requirements, evaluating career opportunities, and completing the admission process. This is where student counselling plays a vital role. Effective counselling helps students make informed decisions and ensures they select programs that align with their educational background, career aspirations, and personal circumstances.

Why Student Counselling Matters

Student counselling is much more than providing information about courses. It involves understanding each learner's individual needs and guiding them throughout the admission journey. Every student has unique goals, financial considerations, and professional ambitions. A counsellor must carefully assess these factors before recommending an appropriate academic program.

During my internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., I observed that many students were unaware of the advantages of online degree programs. They often had concerns regarding university recognition, placement opportunities, examination patterns, learning methodologies, and career growth. Through personalized counselling, these concerns were addressed effectively, helping students make confident admission decisions.

Technology in Modern Counselling

The use of Customer Relationship Management (CRM) software has significantly improved counselling efficiency. CRM systems help counsellors maintain student records, schedule follow-up calls, monitor admission progress, and ensure timely communication. Digital tools enable organizations to deliver personalized services while managing thousands of student enquiries simultaneously.

Similarly, platforms such as Online Manipal provide students with access to digital classrooms, recorded lectures, assignments, examinations, and academic support. Counsellors play an essential role in helping students understand these digital learning platforms and making them comfortable with online education.

Challenges in Student Counselling

Admission counselling is not without challenges. Students often compare multiple universities before making a decision, while others require repeated follow-ups before completing their admission process. Counsellors must possess excellent communication skills, patience, empathy, and product knowledge to effectively address student concerns.

Maintaining accurate records, achieving admission targets, and providing high-quality customer service simultaneously requires effective time management and organizational skills.

Conclusion

Student counselling has become one of the most critical functions in the rapidly growing Ed-Tech industry. It not only assists students in choosing suitable educational programs but also contributes to higher admission conversion rates and improved learner satisfaction.

My internship experience at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. demonstrated that successful counselling combines professional communication, technological competence, empathy, and a genuine commitment to helping learners achieve their academic and career goals. As online education continues to expand, student counselling will remain an indispensable component of quality higher education.

- **Vinayak C Halingali**

Annexure 2

WHITE PAPER

Enhancing Student Counselling and Admission Processes in Online Higher Education: Best Practices and Future Opportunities

Executive Summary

The rapid expansion of online higher education has transformed the way universities deliver academic programs. As digital learning becomes increasingly popular, organizations must develop efficient counselling and admission processes to meet the expectations of modern learners. This white paper examines the importance of student counselling, technology-enabled admission management, and continuous learner support in improving enrollment outcomes and student satisfaction.

The observations presented are based on practical exposure gained during an internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd., an Educational Technology (Ed-Tech) organization that partners with universities such as Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Manipal University Jaipur (MUJ), and Sikkim Manipal University (SMU).

Current Scenario

Online higher education has experienced significant growth due to increased internet penetration, smartphone usage, flexible learning models, and government support for digital education. Students now have access to recognized university degree programs through online learning platforms.

Despite these advancements, many learners require guidance regarding program selection, eligibility criteria, admission procedures, fee structures, and career prospects. Consequently, admission counselling has become a strategic function within the Ed-Tech industry.

Importance of Effective Counselling

Effective student counselling contributes to better educational decision-making by helping learners understand available opportunities and select programs aligned with their career objectives.

A structured counselling process generally includes:

- Understanding the student's academic background.
- Identifying career aspirations.
- Explaining suitable university programs.
- Clarifying eligibility criteria.

- Assisting with documentation.
- Supporting online application submission.
- Providing continuous follow-up until enrollment.

This systematic approach improves admission conversion rates while enhancing student satisfaction and organizational credibility.

Role of Technology

Technology has significantly improved the efficiency of admission management.

Customer Relationship Management (CRM) systems allow organizations to manage student enquiries, maintain communication records, schedule follow-ups, and generate performance reports.

Learning Management Systems (LMS) provide students with digital classrooms, study materials, recorded lectures, assignments, assessments, and academic support services through integrated online platforms.

The combination of CRM technology and digital learning platforms creates a seamless educational experience from initial enquiry through program completion.

Recommendations

Based on the internship observations, the following recommendations are proposed:

- Provide continuous professional training for admission counsellors.
- Strengthen CRM capabilities using Artificial Intelligence and predictive analytics.
- Increase awareness through webinars, career guidance sessions, and educational campaigns.
- Offer personalized counselling based on student aspirations and educational background.
- Enhance career support services, including placement guidance and employability training.
- Invest in advanced digital learning technologies to improve learner engagement and academic outcomes.

Conclusion

Student counselling has become a strategic success factor within the online higher education

sector. Organizations that combine personalized counselling, efficient technology, strong university partnerships, and learner-centric services are better positioned to achieve sustainable growth and higher student satisfaction.

The internship at UNext Learning Pvt. Ltd. demonstrated that effective counselling extends beyond admissions. It builds trust, supports informed educational decisions, and contributes to long-term learner success. As the Ed-Tech industry continues to evolve, organizations must continuously innovate their counselling and admission processes to meet the changing expectations of students and the digital education ecosystem.

